25901368 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCLIS200 - RESEARCH METHODS AND SCHOLARLY COMMUNICATION

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. Classify the relationship between research and development. [U] / [CO1]

   a). No relationship b). Development avoids research

   c). Research leads to development d). Both are unrelated

2. [U] / [CO2]

   Why is the interview method considered time-consuming?

   a). It avoids planning b). It involves recording, transcription, and analysis

   c). It uses secondary data d). It limits interaction

3. In the h-index, what does 'h' represent? [K] / [CO3]

   a). Number of highly cited papers b). A researcher has h papers with at least h citations each

   c). The highest cited paper d). The total number of publications

4. Which tool is an open-source research data repository platform that provides DOIs, versioning, access controls, and is often hosted institutionally (e.g., Harvard Dataverse)? [U] / [CO4]

a).DMPonline b).DMPTool

c).Dataverse d).Figshare

5. A questionnaire is mainly used to [K] / [CO2]

a). Observe behaviour b). Collect written responses

c). Conduct experiments d). Analyse statistics

6. Encyclopedias and indexes are examples of: [K] / [CO1]

a).Primary sources b).Secondary sources

c).Tertiary sources d).Empirical sources

7. Which operating systems are supported by Zotero and Mendeley? [U] / [CO4]

a).Windows only b).Linux only

c).Windows, macOS, and Linux d).Android only

8. What is a preprint? [K] / [CO3]

a). Printed book b). Final journal copy

c). Magazine article d). Research paper before peer review and Publication

9. Which of the following is a major advantage of online survey tools like Google Forms? [U] / [CO4]

a). Requires physical distribution b). Automatic data collection and analysis

c). Limited response storage d). Only text-based questions allowed

10. How do hypotheses function in quantitative research? [U] / [CO2]

a). They describe experiences b). They guide data interpretation

c). They are tested using statistical methods d). They explain personal meanings

11. Why is IRB approval required for research involving human participants? [U] / [CO1]

a). To increase funding

b). To improve writing style

c). To protect participants' rights and safety

d). To reduce research time

12. Descriptive research aims to [U] / [CO4]

a). Explain causes

b). Describe characteristics

c). Test hypotheses

d). Predict outcomes

[2x10 = 20]

Part B

Short Essay Questions

Answer any **4** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

13. Describe the major sources from which research problems can be identified. [U] / [CO1]

14. Describe the concept and main purpose of qualitative research. [U] / [CO2]

15. Discuss the importance of data preservation for future research. [U] / [CO3]

16. What does SPSS stand for? Briefly explain its merits and demerits. [U] / [CO4]

17. Identify the major steps involved in the survey method. [K] / [CO2]

18. Explain the types of data that can be analysed using NVivo. [A] / [CO4]

[5x4 = 20]

Part C

Essay Questions

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

19. Explain the FAIR data principles and examine how Figshare ensures compliance with FAIR guidelines. [U] / [CO4]

20. Describe the major types of research based on application and explain their interrelationship. [K] / [CO1]

21. Explain how patent information supports industrial research. [U] / [CO3]

22. What is sampling technique? Compare probability and non-probability sampling methods. [K] / [CO2]

[15x2 = 30]